

# Men's Ballon d'Or

France Football created the Ballon d'Or in 1956. Eligibility rules changed over time: the award was initially limited to European players, opened to players of any nationality at European clubs in 1995, and became fully global in 2007. From 2010 through 2015 it was presented jointly with FIFA.

## Men's Ballon d'Or winners, 1956 to present

| Year                 | Winner                          | National team | Ceremony date     | Story                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------|---------------------------------|---------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">2025</a> | <a href="#">Ousmane Dembélé</a> | France        | 22 September 2025 | —                                                                                                                                            |
| <a href="#">2024</a> | <a href="#">Rodri</a>           | Spain         | 28 October 2024   | —                                                                                                                                            |
| <a href="#">2023</a> | <a href="#">Lionel Messi</a>    | Argentina     | 30 October 2023   | —                                                                                                                                            |
| <a href="#">2022</a> | <a href="#">Karim Benzema</a>   | France        | 17 October 2022   | —                                                                                                                                            |
| <a href="#">2021</a> | <a href="#">Lionel Messi</a>    | Argentina     | 29 November 2021  | —                                                                                                                                            |
| <a href="#">2020</a> | <a href="#">Not awarded</a>     | —             | —                 | <a href="#">▶ Tap to read the story</a><br>The 2020 Ballon d'Or was the only edition since the award's creation in 1956 not to be presented. |

| Year        | Winner                                   | National team | Ceremony date    | Story                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------------|------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <u>2019</u> | <u><a href="#">Lionel Messi</a></u>      | Argentina     | 2 December 2019  | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2018</u> | <u><a href="#">Luka Modrić</a></u>       | Croatia       | 3 December 2018  | <p>►  Tap to read the story</p> <p>Luka Modrić became the only Croatian winner of the Ballon d'Or in 2018.</p>                                                  |
| <u>2017</u> | <u><a href="#">Cristiano Ronaldo</a></u> | Portugal      | 7 December 2017  | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2016</u> | <u><a href="#">Cristiano Ronaldo</a></u> | Portugal      | 12 December 2016 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2015</u> | <u><a href="#">Lionel Messi</a></u>      | Argentina     | 11 January 2016  | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2014</u> | <u><a href="#">Cristiano Ronaldo</a></u> | Portugal      | 12 January 2015  | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2013</u> | <u><a href="#">Cristiano Ronaldo</a></u> | Portugal      | 13 January 2014  | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2012</u> | <u><a href="#">Lionel Messi</a></u>      | Argentina     | 7 January 2013   | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2011</u> | <u><a href="#">Lionel Messi</a></u>      | Argentina     | 9 January 2012   | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2010</u> | <u><a href="#">Lionel Messi</a></u>      | Argentina     | 10 January 2011  | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2009</u> | <u><a href="#">Lionel Messi</a></u>      | Argentina     | 1 December 2009  | <p>►  Tap to read the story</p> <p>Lionel Messi won the first of his eight Ballon d'Or titles in 2009, more than any other player in the award's history.</p> |

| Year        | Winner                                   | National team  | Ceremony date    | Story                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------------|------------------------------------------|----------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <u>2008</u> | <u><a href="#">Cristiano Ronaldo</a></u> | Portugal       | 2 December 2008  | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2007</u> | <u><a href="#">Kaká</a></u>              | Brazil         | 2 December 2007  | <p>▶  <a href="#">Tap to read the story</a></p> <p>Kaká won the 2007 Ballon d'Or, the first year the award opened to any nationality at any club worldwide.</p> |
| <u>2006</u> | <u><a href="#">Fabio Cannavaro</a></u>   | Italy          | 27 November 2006 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2005</u> | <u><a href="#">Ronaldinho</a></u>        | Brazil         | 28 November 2005 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2004</u> | <u><a href="#">Andriy Shevchenko</a></u> | Ukraine        | 13 December 2004 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2003</u> | <u><a href="#">Pavel Nedvěd</a></u>      | Czech Republic | 22 December 2003 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2002</u> | <u><a href="#">Ronaldo</a></u>           | Brazil         | 12 December 2002 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2001</u> | <u><a href="#">Michael Owen</a></u>      | England        | 18 December 2001 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>2000</u> | <u><a href="#">Luís Figo</a></u>         | Portugal       | 19 December 2000 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

| Year        | Winner                                   | National team | Ceremony date    | Story                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------|------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <u>1999</u> | <u><a href="#">Rivaldo</a></u>           | Brazil        | 21 December 1999 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <u>1998</u> | <u><a href="#">Zinedine Zidane</a></u>   | France        | 22 December 1998 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <u>1997</u> | <u><a href="#">Ronaldo</a></u>           | Brazil        | 23 December 1997 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <u>1996</u> | <u><a href="#">Matthias Sammer</a></u>   | Germany       | 24 December 1996 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <u>1995</u> | <u><a href="#">George Weah</a></u>       | Liberia       | 26 December 1995 | <p>►  <a href="#">Tap to read the story</a></p> <p>George Weah became the first African player to win the Ballon d'Or in 1995.</p> |
| <u>1994</u> | <u><a href="#">Hristo Stoichkov</a></u>  | Bulgaria      | 20 December 1994 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <u>1993</u> | <u><a href="#">Roberto Baggio</a></u>    | Italy         | 28 December 1993 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <u>1992</u> | <u><a href="#">Marco van Basten</a></u>  | Netherlands   | 22 December 1992 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <u>1991</u> | <u><a href="#">Jean-Pierre Papin</a></u> | France        | 24 December 1991 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

| Year        | Winner                                       | National team | Ceremony date    | Story |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------|-------|
| <u>1990</u> | <u><a href="#">Lothar Matthäus</a></u>       | West Germany  | 25 December 1990 | —     |
| <u>1989</u> | <u><a href="#">Marco van Basten</a></u>      | Netherlands   | 26 December 1989 | —     |
| <u>1988</u> | <u><a href="#">Marco van Basten</a></u>      | Netherlands   | 27 December 1988 | —     |
| <u>1987</u> | <u><a href="#">Ruud Gullit</a></u>           | Netherlands   | 29 December 1987 | —     |
| <u>1986</u> | <u><a href="#">Igor Belanov</a></u>          | Soviet Union  | 30 December 1986 | —     |
| <u>1985</u> | <u><a href="#">Michel Platini</a></u>        | France        | 24 December 1985 | —     |
| <u>1984</u> | <u><a href="#">Michel Platini</a></u>        | France        | 25 December 1984 | —     |
| <u>1983</u> | <u><a href="#">Michel Platini</a></u>        | France        | 27 December 1983 | —     |
| <u>1982</u> | <u><a href="#">Paolo Rossi</a></u>           | Italy         | 28 December 1982 | —     |
| <u>1981</u> | <u><a href="#">Karl-Heinz Rummenigge</a></u> | West Germany  | 29 December 1981 | —     |

| <b>Year</b> | <b>Winner</b>                                | <b>National team</b> | <b>Ceremony date</b> | <b>Story</b> |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|--------------|
| <u>1980</u> | <a href="#"><u>Karl-Heinz Rummenigge</u></a> | West Germany         | 30 December 1980     | —            |
| <u>1979</u> | <a href="#"><u>Kevin Keegan</u></a>          | England              | 25 December 1979     | —            |
| <u>1978</u> | <a href="#"><u>Kevin Keegan</u></a>          | England              | 27 December 1978     | —            |
| <u>1977</u> | <a href="#"><u>Allan Simonsen</u></a>        | Denmark              | 27 December 1977     | —            |
| <u>1976</u> | <a href="#"><u>Franz Beckenbauer</u></a>     | West Germany         | 28 December 1976     | —            |
| <u>1975</u> | <a href="#"><u>Oleg Blokhin</u></a>          | Soviet Union         | 30 December 1975     | —            |
| <u>1974</u> | <a href="#"><u>Johan Cruyff</u></a>          | Netherlands          | 31 December 1974     | —            |
| <u>1973</u> | <a href="#"><u>Johan Cruyff</u></a>          | Netherlands          | 25 December 1973     | —            |
| <u>1972</u> | <a href="#"><u>Franz Beckenbauer</u></a>     | West Germany         | 26 December 1972     | —            |
| <u>1971</u> | <a href="#"><u>Johan Cruyff</u></a>          | Netherlands          | 28 December 1971     | —            |

| Year        | Winner                                | National team    | Ceremony date    | Story |
|-------------|---------------------------------------|------------------|------------------|-------|
| <u>1970</u> | <u><a href="#">Gerd Müller</a></u>    | West Germany     | 29 December 1970 | —     |
| <u>1969</u> | <u><a href="#">Gianni Rivera</a></u>  | Italy            | 23 December 1969 | —     |
| <u>1968</u> | <u><a href="#">George Best</a></u>    | Northern Ireland | 24 December 1968 | —     |
| <u>1967</u> | <u><a href="#">Flórián Albert</a></u> | Hungary          | 26 December 1967 | —     |
| <u>1966</u> | <u><a href="#">Bobby Charlton</a></u> | England          | 27 December 1966 | —     |
| <u>1965</u> | <u><a href="#">Eusébio</a></u>        | Portugal         | 28 December 1965 | —     |
| <u>1964</u> | <u><a href="#">Denis Law</a></u>      | Scotland         | 22 December 1964 | —     |
| <u>1963</u> | <u><a href="#">Lev Yashin</a></u>     | Soviet Union     | 17 December 1963 | —     |
| <u>1962</u> | <u><a href="#">Josef Masopust</a></u> | Czechoslovakia   | 18 December 1962 | —     |
| <u>1961</u> | <u><a href="#">Omar Sívori</a></u>    | Italy            | 12 December 1961 | —     |

| Year        | Winner                             | National team | Ceremony date    | Story                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------------|------------------------------------|---------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <u>1960</u> | <a href="#">Luis Suárez</a>        | Spain         | 13 December 1960 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>1959</u> | <a href="#">Alfredo Di Stéfano</a> | Spain         | 15 December 1959 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>1958</u> | <a href="#">Raymond Kopa</a>       | France        | 16 December 1958 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>1957</u> | <a href="#">Alfredo Di Stéfano</a> | Spain         | 17 December 1957 | —                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <u>1956</u> | <a href="#">Stanley Matthews</a>   | England       | 18 December 1956 | <p>▶  <a href="#">Tap to read the story</a></p> <p>Stanley Matthews won the first-ever Ballon d'Or in 1956.</p> |

## Champions by titles

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

### Lionel Messi

8

2009, 2010, 2011, 2012, 2015, 2019, 2021, 2023

### Cristiano Ronaldo

5

2008, 2013, 2014, 2016, 2017

### Johan Cruyff

3

1971, 1973, 1974



|                                                            |          |
|------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Michel Platini</b><br><div></div><br>1983, 1984, 1985   | <b>3</b> |
| <b>Marco van Basten</b><br><div></div><br>1988, 1989, 1992 | <b>3</b> |
| <b>Alfredo Di Stéfano</b><br><div></div><br>1957, 1959     | <b>2</b> |
| <b>Franz Beckenbauer</b><br><div></div><br>1972, 1976      | <b>2</b> |
| <b>Kevin Keegan</b><br><div></div><br>1978, 1979           | <b>2</b> |
| <b>Karl-Heinz Rummenigge</b><br><div></div><br>1980, 1981  | <b>2</b> |
| <b>Ronaldo</b><br><div></div><br>1997, 2002                | <b>2</b> |
| <b>Stanley Matthews</b><br><div></div><br>1956             | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Raymond Kopa</b><br><div></div><br>1958                 | <b>1</b> |

|                                                                                                                      |          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Luis Suárez</b><br><br>1960      | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Omar Sívori</b><br><br>1961      | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Josef Masopust</b><br><br>1962   | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Lev Yashin</b><br><br>1963       | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Denis Law</b><br><br>1964        | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Eusébio</b><br><br>1965          | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Bobby Charlton</b><br><br>1966 | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Flórián Albert</b><br><br>1967 | <b>1</b> |
| <b>George Best</b><br><br>1968    | <b>1</b> |

|                                                                                                                         |          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Gianni Rivera</b><br><br>1969       | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Gerd Müller</b><br><br>1970         | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Oleg Blokhin</b><br><br>1975        | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Allan Simonsen</b><br><br>1977      | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Paolo Rossi</b><br><br>1982         | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Igor Belanov</b><br><br>1986        | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Ruud Gullit</b><br><br>1987       | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Lothar Matthäus</b><br><br>1990   | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Jean-Pierre Papin</b><br><br>1991 | <b>1</b> |

|                                                                                                                      |          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Roberto Baggio</b><br><br>1993   | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Hristo Stoichkov</b><br><br>1994 | <b>1</b> |
| <b>George Weah</b><br><br>1995      | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Matthias Sammer</b><br><br>1996  | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Zinedine Zidane</b><br><br>1998  | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Rivaldo</b><br><br>1999          | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Luís Figo</b><br><br>2000      | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Michael Owen</b><br><br>2001   | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Pavel Nedvěd</b><br><br>2003   | <b>1</b> |

|                                                                                     |          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Andriy Shevchenko</b>                                                            | <b>1</b> |
|    |          |
| 2004                                                                                |          |
| <b>Ronaldinho</b>                                                                   | <b>1</b> |
|    |          |
| 2005                                                                                |          |
| <b>Fabio Cannavaro</b>                                                              | <b>1</b> |
|    |          |
| 2006                                                                                |          |
| <b>Kaká</b>                                                                         | <b>1</b> |
|    |          |
| 2007                                                                                |          |
| <b>Luka Modrić</b>                                                                  | <b>1</b> |
|    |          |
| 2018                                                                                |          |
| <b>Karim Benzema</b>                                                                | <b>1</b> |
|    |          |
| 2022                                                                                |          |
| <b>Rodri</b>                                                                        | <b>1</b> |
|  |          |
| 2024                                                                                |          |
| <b>Ousmane Dembélé</b>                                                              | <b>1</b> |
|  |          |
| 2025                                                                                |          |

## How it works

- The Ballon d'Or honors the best individual men's player of the year - it is not a team competition or a national-team trophy.

- A panel of football journalists, one from each eligible country, ranks their top players; the votes are combined into one final ranking.
- Eligibility has widened over time: Europe-only at first, then any nationality at a European club from 1995, then fully global since 2007 (see the introduction above).
- The winner is announced at an end-of-year ceremony organized by France Football magazine.

## **Memorable moments**

- Stanley Matthews won the first-ever Ballon d'Or in 1956.
- George Weah became the first African player to win the Ballon d'Or in 1995.
- Kaká won the 2007 Ballon d'Or, the first year the award opened to any nationality at any club worldwide.
- Lionel Messi won the first of his eight Ballon d'Or titles in 2009, more than any other player in the award's history.
- Luka Modrić became the only Croatian winner of the Ballon d'Or in 2018.
- The 2020 Ballon d'Or was the only edition since the award's creation in 1956 not to be presented.

## **Notes**

- Lev Yashin remains the only goalkeeper to win the men's award.
- George Weah became the first African winner in 1995.
- Luka Modrić won in 2018.
- The 2020 award was cancelled.
- Ousmane Dembélé won the 2025 award.

## **References & review**

**Status: verified**

Last reviewed: 26 August 2026

- Official winners and rankings (<https://ballondor.com/all-rankings>).
- Official homepage (<https://ballondor.com/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/europa-poy65.html>).

- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.britannica.com/topic/Ballon-dOr>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.jeuneafrique.com/381505/politique/jour-26-deceembre-1995-george-weah-elu-ballon-dor/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.voanews.com/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.uefa.com/uefachampionsleague/news/>).

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.